

ACTIVITY 5 — LEARNER WORKSHEET**Control — Hold the Gain and Hand Over**

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Hands-on Lab	30 minutes	CONTROL	Control — Hold the Gain

Name	
Date	

What you are doing

The pilot worked. The countermeasure was made permanent and the improvement team was stood down. Four weeks later the team has been asked to review how it is holding up.

What you will produce: A completed control plan with a reaction plan, a visual board sketch, a short SOP, a daily huddle plan, and a one-page summary of the whole DMAIC story naming the process owner.

The scenario

The daily figures have been collected throughout. Weeks 1 and 2 look good. In week 3 something goes wrong: a new opening staff member was never shown the restock step, the measure degrades for five consecutive days, and nobody notices until a customer complains publicly on the Friday. Week 4 recovers once the SOP is pinned up and the handover is done properly.

Most improvements work for a fortnight and then quietly disappear. Your job is to close the BrewBean Cafe story by deciding what will be measured from now on, who owns it, what happens when it slips, and how the improved process is handed back to the people who run it every day.

Your steps

1. **Choose the control measure** — Open data/post-improvement-monitoring.csv — four weeks of daily figures after the pilot was made permanent. Choose the ONE measure that tells you the improvement is still working. One or two measures watched properly beat five that nobody looks at.
2. **Complete the control plan** — Look at data/control-plan-example.csv for the worked first row, then complete templates/control-plan-template.csv: what is measured, the target, how often it is checked, where it is recorded, and who owns it. Name one role as owner — a control plan owned by 'the team' is owned by nobody.
3. **Write the reaction plan** — Write the exact steps to take when the measure misses target. 'Investigate' and 'escalate' are not reaction plans — say what the supervisor physically does tomorrow morning. Then find week 3 in the monitoring data and state which day your plan would have triggered on.

4. **Design the visual board** — Sketch a simple board that would have made the week-3 drift visible to the whole shift on day one. A run of the daily figure beats a single number, because drift shows up as a trend long before anyone calls it a problem.
5. **Write the SOP** — In templates/sop-and-huddle-template.csv, turn your Activity 4 standard work into a short SOP the cafe could actually pin up — and state how anyone would know the step was done.
6. **Plan the daily huddle** — Complete the huddle rows: who attends, what time, how long, what is reviewed and who runs it. Five minutes at the board is enough. The rule that makes huddles work: problems are named, not blamed.
7. **Summarise and hand over** — Using templates/one-page-summary-template.csv, summarise the whole project — problem, cause, countermeasure, result and control — then name who you hand it over to and when. A White Belt project that stays with the improvement team has not finished.

Your working space

Complete every field. You may keep this worksheet and refer to it during the open-book assessment.

Step 1 — Choose the control measure

Step 2 — Complete the control plan

Step 3 — Write the reaction plan

Step 4 — Design the visual board

Step 5 — Write the SOP

Step 6 — Plan the daily huddle

Step 7 — Summarise and hand over

Answers to the discussion prompts

1. Looking at the monitoring data, which day would a good control plan have triggered on — and how many customers were affected before anyone noticed?

2. Which of your measures is a leading indicator and which is lagging? Why does the difference matter here?

3. What makes a reaction plan actionable rather than just a statement of intent?

4. Who should own this process now that the improvement team has disbanded, and why that person?

Reflect & discuss

The countermeasure was correct and the improvement still decayed. What does that tell you about the Control phase?

What would week 3 have looked like if the visual board had already been in place?

Which improvement in your own workplace has quietly drifted back, and what control was missing?

Check your work

Every group can show a control plan naming a measure, target, frequency and a single named owner; a reaction plan that says what to DO; and a one-page summary telling the complete DMAIC story from problem to named handover.